Brochure 2

Matching & Selection Procedure

BSc Computer Science & Engineering

2027-2028



Brochure 2 – Matching & Selection CSE

Matching & Selection Procedure

This brochure explains what to expect when participating in the BSc Computer Science & Engineering Matching & Selection procedure. The deadline for applying for CSE at the TU Delft is **January 15**. Note that this is a fixed deadline.

If you are doubting whether you should study CSE at the TU Delft, please read *Brochure 1 – 'Choosing your studies - BSc* CSE' on the M&S webpage.

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Bachelor Computer Science & Engineering

During the bachelor Computer Science and Engineering (BSc CSE) you will learn how computers, networks and embedded systems work. You will study algorithms and address questions such as: “What is an algorithm?” and “How can you represent information in a computer?” You will learn how to model complex systems and develop software solutions for problems. During this study programme you will often work in teams to tackle real-world challenges. This collaborative environment will not only enrich your learning experience, but will also prepare you for teamwork essential in your future career. More information on studying CSE at TU Delft can be found in “Brochure 1 – Choosing your studies - BSc CSE”.

Who are we looking for?

- Curious problem-solvers and profound analytical engineers
- Pro-active team workers who can collaborate and communicate well
- Competent learners with good planning and self-regulatory skills
- Disciplined students who are capable of handling a large amount of self-study
- Students who adhere to and identify with the TU Delft values: Diversity, Integrity, Respect, Engagement, Courage and Trust (DIRECT), as embodied in the TU Delft Code of Conduct.



Tracks

TU Delft offers two tracks for the CSE programme: The English track and the Bilingual track (Dutch-English). The English track is fully taught in English. To enrol in the Bilingual track, students need to be proficient in Dutch and English, as you will also write and present in Dutch. Students with a foreign diploma are only admissible for the English track, unless they can show a Dutch language proficiency certificate. You can find more information about language requirements here.

Matching & Selection procedure in short

Computer Science & Engineering at TU Delft is a Numerus Clausus programme. There is a maximum capacity of 590 first-year students. 345 spots are reserved for the English track and 245 spots for the Bilingual track. Because more people apply, there is a Matching & Selection (M&S) procedure. You can only participate in the M&S procedure if you have successfully applied in Studielink before **15 January**. After completing the M&S procedure, you will receive a ranking number, which will determine your chance of receiving a seat for CSE.

Matching

During the Matching part of the procedure you will dive into several topics that are taught in the bachelor to get a better impression of studying CSE at TU Delft. The Matching activities are mandatory and need to be completed to receive a ranking number, but they will not influence your place in the ranking.

On page 13 you can find a timeline with all the deadlines of the M&S procedure.

Selection

In the Selection part, you will complete a selection test (Cognitive Skills Test, CST) which determines the chance you have of receiving a higher (= better) ranking number. If you aspire to perform well on the selection test, we strongly recommend that you prepare yourself. You can prepare for the selection test by studying the materials on page 10 in this brochure. You can start preparing for the CST even before the M&S preproduce begins.

The selection test will cover the following two topics:

- Mathematics (50%)
- Systematic Reasoning and Logical Thinking (50%)

It is possible to fully complete the M&S procedure online. We also offer the opportunity to take the CST on campus and/or attend the preparation lecture at TU Delft, but all other activities will be online for everyone.

Regulations

All rules governing the M&S procedure can be found in the Regulation Matching & Selection Criteria and Procedure, which can be downloaded from the website.

Matching & Selection Procedure in 10 steps

Step 1 – Register in Studielink before January 15

To apply and participate in the Matching & Selection procedure, you need to register for the CSE programme in Studielink, the Dutch national enrolment system for higher education.

In Studielink you can find CSE under 'Study Programmes' → 'Add new enrolment application' → Educational Institution: Delft University of Education → 'Computer Science & Engineering – Bachelor'.

You will see two study programmes to choose from! If you want to register for the English track, select the programme with only the British flag. If you want to register for the Bilingual track, select the programme with the double (Dutch and British) flag

Mathematics B (or equivalent) is a requirement for admission. VWO students and applicants who fulfill the Dutch language requirements can enrol in the Bilingual track. International students who fulfill the English language requirements can enrol in the English track. More information about the admission and language requirements can be found on the Admission Requirements page.

Please note that it takes time to obtain a login for Studielink, to collect the required documents and to complete your application. If you have an international secondary school diploma, make sure to continue your application in the online application system of TU Delft and submit your complete application file by 15 January. These deadlines are fixed, as we need to comply with strict national deadlines set by the Dutch government.

Admissions Office & Contact Centre

Checking whether you meet the admission requirements, such as a suitable diploma and payment details, is done by the TU Delft Admissions Office and is a process that continues from your initial application until the start of the academic year. Please keep an eye on the status of your application as you may need to submit additional documents. For questions regarding your application, you can send an email to the contact centre at: contactcentre-esa@tudelft.nl.

Email

Please note that the email address you use in Studielink will also be the email address that is used for the M&S procedure. This email address will be your unique identifier throughout the whole procedure and you cannot change it during the procedure! Keep in mind that you will be kept informed through email on a regular basis about the next steps in the procedure. You need access to the Studielink email address until the beginning of the study year (September 2027).

Step 2 – Start Matching & Selection procedure

After the Studielink registration deadline has passed (15 Jan), the first communication regarding the M&S procedure will be by email, which you will receive on your Studielink email address by **Wednesday 20 January** at the latest. The M&S procedure will begin immediately after receiving this email. In this first email you will be asked to do the following:

- Complete the 'Studying at the TU Delft' survey
- Choose a preferred slot for the CST (selection test)
- Choose a preferred slot for the Teamwork Assignment
- Start with the OSE (Online Student Experience)

These steps are part of the Matching procedure and will not be used to calculate your ranking number, but you need to complete them to continue with the M&S procedure. To ensure you do not miss any M&S emails, green list: selection-bsc-cse@tudelft.nl and check your spam.

Step 3 – Online Student Experience (OSE)

The OSE is part of the Matching and is meant to help you gain a better impression of the CSE study programme. You will be introduced to a practical problem and apply computer science techniques to that domain. You need to complete the OSE before **Tuesday 2 February 23:59 CET**. Although the OSE will not be used to calculate your ranking number, you need to complete the OSE to continue with the M&S procedure, so make sure to answer all questions of the OSE in a meaningful way.

Step 4 – CST Preparation Lecture

In the week of 2 February (date and time to be announced) you can attend a lecture in which a Mathematics lecturer and Systematic Reasoning & Logical Thinking lecturer will go through some exercises to help you with preparing for the CST. You can follow the lecture via a livestream or attend on campus. Attending the lecture on campus gives you the opportunity to ask questions regarding the study materials. You will receive the study materials and location of the lecture in advance. Following the lecture is not mandatory.

Step 5 – Confirmation CST Date

If you have completed the OSE, you will receive the confirmation of your CST date and Teamwork timeslot after the OSE deadline and before Tuesday 9 February. There is a fixed number of places per CST date. If the number of candidates exceeds the available seats for a specific slot, you may be assigned one of your other slot choices.

Step 6 – Proctoring Trial Run & Selection Platform

From **Tuesday 9 - Tuesday 16 February 23:59 CET** you will have the opportunity to test if the proctoring software works on your computer. Please keep in mind that you are personally responsible for assuring good working equipment and a well-functioning internet connection.

Step 7 - Take the Cognitive Skills Test

The CST can be completed online on **Thursday 18 February or Tuesday 23 February between 10:00-22:00 CET.** You will take the CST on the date confirmed to you. More information about the CST can be found on the next pages of this brochure.

Step 8 – Complete the Teamwork Assignment (TwA)

For the last step of the procedure, you will be assigned to a team. Although the Teamwork Assignment will not be used to determine your ranking number, you need to complete the Teamwork Assignment in a meaningful way in order to receive your ranking number. The Teamwork Assignment consists of 2 parts:

1. Introduction: Say hello to the rest of the team by writing a short introduction (**Tuesday 2 to Thursday 4 March**).
2. Team challenge: For the team challenge (takes 1 hour) you will come together online with your team during a chosen timeslot (either on **Monday 8 or Tuesday 9 March**).

Step 9 – Receive your Ranking Number

You will receive your ranking number in Studielink on 15 April. If your ranking number is within the fixed capacity of your track, you will automatically receive a (conditional[*]) offer for the academic year 2027-2028. If your ranking number is higher, it is possible to receive an offer at a later point in time, as not all candidates will accept their spot.

Step 10 – Accept your spot

Make sure to check your email regularly as you need to accept a spot within 2 weeks in Studielink. Remember to finalize your registration and upload all required documents.

[*] Please note that participating in the Matching & Selection procedure or receiving a ranking number does not automatically mean that you meet the admission requirements, as this constitutes a separate process. Even after having received your ranking number, your application can be cancelled, for example if you do not obtain your diploma or if you fail to pay the tuition fee in time.

Taking the Cognitive Skills Test

The Cognitive Skills Test (CST) contains the following two tests:

- Mathematics (50%)
- Systematic Reasoning & Logical Thinking (50%)

The percentages between brackets indicate the relative weight used to calculate your final score. The complete CST will take a maximum of 1 hour and 45 minutes to complete. You will get 1 hour for Mathematics and 45 minutes for Systematic Reasoning & Logical Thinking. Per test a counter will stay visible showing the remaining time. Once you start the first test, you must complete both tests in one session. You cannot re-sit or re-take the CST.

We offer the CST on set dates and within set time windows. It is not possible to take the CST on another date or time. At the start of the M&S procedure you will be asked to submit your CST date preference.

Extra time CST

Candidates who have been diagnosed with a support need can request extra time for the CST by sending an email to selectie-esa@tudelft.nl. Requests need to be supported with official documentation, written in English or Dutch and can be submitted after the registration deadline (15 January) and before **Friday 5 February 10:00 CET**. Read the extra time information in the FAQ: 'Matching & Selection' for the mandatory instructions on submitting your request.

Tracks & CST

For candidates in the English track, the procedure will be entirely in English. Candidates in the Bilingual track will do the Mathematics part of the CST in Dutch. The rest of the procedure will be in English and is the same for both tracks.

Proctoring

To ensure an honest selection procedure all candidates will be remotely proctored during the CTS, which means that candidates are "followed" online to check whether the test is completed under the correct conditions. You and your computer screen will be monitored during the CST to ensure that you comply with the academic integrity standards of the TU Delft. TU Delft cannot guarantee that proctoring will work in all countries, as some countries have strict regulations and firewalls, which may mean that you require a VPN connection. You are personally responsible for ensuring that you are able to take the CST online.

Academic Integrity during the CST

It is important that you have a good environment to take the CST. Make sure that your phone is completely switched off and out of sight. Let the people around you know that you are taking the CST so they do not disturb you or make a lot of noise which could distract you during the test. You will need to take the test individually and without other sources of information. It is not allowed to share questions or answers of the CST with third parties. Violation of these rules, and/or the rules listed below, can result in a sanction by the Selection Committee. All candidates taking the CST need to comply with the academic integrity standards of the TU Delft. Any (attempted) act or omission thereof that may result in making it more difficult or impossible to form an **objective** assessment, constitutes fraud. The Selection Committee can impose sanctions on fraud or a rule violation, like awarding zero points or excluding a candidate from the procedure.

What is not allowed during the CST

- A calculator is *not* allowed *nor* is a calculator on a mobile device.
- Use of a second computer is *not* allowed.
- Use of a (smart) phone is *not* allowed.
- Use of any other mobile device than the device on which the test is taken.
- Use of headphones or earplugs is *not* allowed.
- Use of documentation other than the documentation permitted for the test.
- Use of search engines or AI tools are *not* allowed.
- Presence of other people in the room while taking the CST proctored.

How to prepare for the Matching & Selection

On the CST you will be tested on 2 selection criteria: Mathematics and Systematic Reasoning & Logical Thinking. Be aware that if you aspire to perform well on the selection test, we strongly recommend that you prepare for the CST. You can start preparing for the CST before the Matching & Selection procedure begins. We do not provide any other preparation materials other than what you can find on this page!

Mathematics

You can prepare for this part by following the free online pre-university calculus course (select the audit track) and by reading the syllabus and formula sheet, which can be found in the appendix of this brochure. The syllabus will give you a better insight into what is expected from you on the test. You should be able to apply techniques and formulas from memory, except for the formulas on the formula sheet, which will be digitally available during the test. Please remember that you will need to do all calculations by yourself as a calculator is not allowed.

Systematic Reasoning & Logical Thinking

You can prepare for this part by studying chapter 2 of the textbook Delftse Foundations of Computation. You can skip all the sections starred (*) in the contents of the book, as explained in chapter 1. This book can be downloaded for free from the TU Delft Open Textbook repository (link on the right). At TU Delft we train our students to become analytical engineers and curious problem-solvers. Although you will find exercises in the book, you will not find any official answers, nor do we provide any more than those already included in the book.



S. Hugtenburg & N. Yorke-Smith (2022)

Delftse Foundations of Computation 2nd Edition

Matching

The Matching part of the procedure consists of the studying at TU Delft survey, Online Student Experience and the Teamwork Assignment. Although these activities are not graded, you have to complete them in order to receive a ranking number. You can prepare for the Matching by allocating time in your agenda for these activities.

Overall time investment

The timeline on page 13 shows an indication of how much time each step will cost at least. Take into consideration that most candidates spend around 15-25 hours preparing for the CST (including the preparation lecture) and that reading all our communication carefully also takes time!

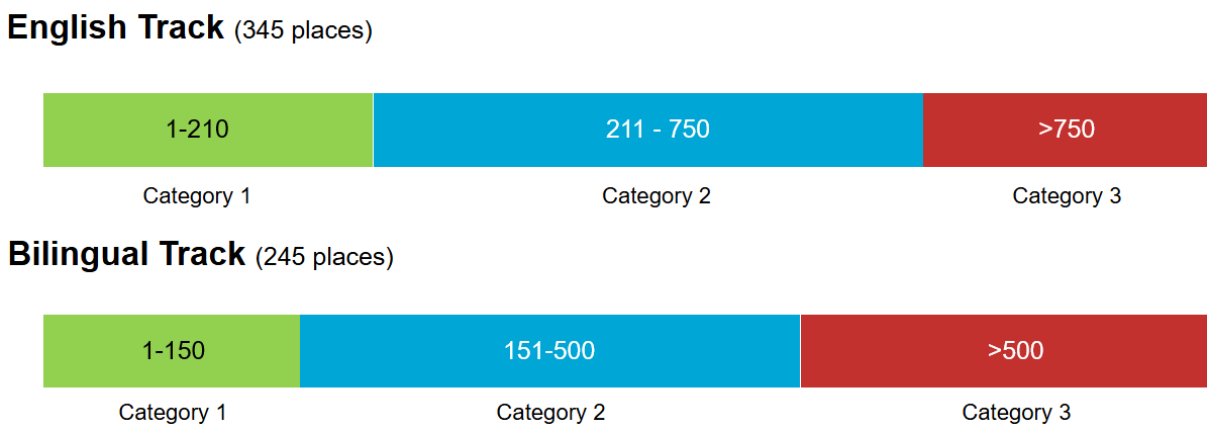
How your ranking number is determined

All candidates must complete all steps in the Matching & Selection procedure in order to obtain a ranking number. The ranking numbers are computed in accordance with a strict protocol. This process is overseen by the CSE Selection Committee. As educational systems differ per country, your high school grades are not taken into consideration when calculating your ranking number.

A separate ranking is made for each language track. For both tracks the same method of selection is used to determine the ranking. Your ranking number will be based on your CST score and a lottery draw.

CST score calculation

Mathematics and Systematic Reasoning & Logical Thinking will each count for 50% towards your final CST score. For each track, the scores of the two tests will be normalized and combined into a score list, ranked from highest scoring to lowest scoring. Your place on the score list of your track will determine your lottery category placement.



Lottery

There are three lottery categories for each track. For the English track, the 210 highest-scoring candidates on the score list are placed in category 1, the next 540 candidates are placed in category 2, and the rest is placed in category 3. For the Bilingual track, the 150 highest-scoring candidates are placed in category 1, the next 350 candidates are placed in category 2, and the rest is placed in category 3.

Within each category a random lottery will determine your final ranking number. The draw will be done by a certified company and under the supervision of a notary. Your final ranking number will be unique within your track and will be chosen randomly from the numbers drawn in the lottery category you belong to.

Ranking number

There are 345 spots reserved for the English track and 245 spots for the Bilingual track. If your final ranking number is 345 or lower (English track) or 245 or lower (Bilingual track), you will receive a direct offer on 15 April. If your final ranking number is higher than 345 (English track) or 245 (Bilingual track), you may receive an offer later.

How ranking works in Studielink

On 15 April, Studielink will announce your ranking number. No feedback will be provided on the selection test scores or the placement on the score list, nor is it possible to review the tests or individual answers given.

Please note that assigning spots is an automated process in Studielink. If your ranking number is within our maximum capacity, you will automatically receive an (conditional*) offer. You will have two weeks to accept this offer in Studielink. If you do not accept or respond within two weeks, this spot will automatically be re-assigned to the next registered candidate on the ranking list who has not received an offer yet.

If your ranking number is higher than the available capacity, you will have to wait until one of the other applicants declines their offer or opt for one of your alternative study choices. Please keep in mind that after 15 April, applicants with ranking numbers above our maximum capacity can still be offered a spot, so make sure to check your email and Studielink on a weekly basis, as this process continues throughout summer.



* Please note that participating in the M&S procedure or receiving a ranking number does not automatically mean that you meet the admission requirements, as this constitutes a separate process. Even after having received your ranking number, your application can be cancelled, for example if you do not obtain your diploma or if you fail to pay the tuition fee in time.

Timeline procedure

Application and Matching & Selection BSc CSE 2027/2028

		Indication of time investment
1. Application A. Apply in Studielink B. Choose your CSE language track C. Activate your TUD Net ID D. Continue in Osiris	**1st Oct - 15th Jan 23:59 CET**	
2. Start Matching & Selection Procedure Including a survey, indication of selection test (CST) preference date and Teamwork timeslot.	**20th Jan – 26th Jan 23:59 CET**	1 hour
3. Online Student Experience (OSE)	**20th Jan – 2nd Feb 23:59 CET**	2-3 hours
4. CST Preparation lecture This lecture is optional.	**Week of 2 February, to be announced**	2 hours
5. Confirmation CST date Receive the confirmation of your selection test (CST) date.	**Before 9th Feb**	
6. Trial Run Proctoring Test the proctoring software on the computer you will use to take the CST.	**9th Feb – 16th Feb 23:59 CET**	1 hour
7. Selection Test (CST) Complete the two parts of the CST, proctored and on your own computer.	**18th Feb or 23rd Feb Between 10:00 – 22:00 CET**	2 hours (+ x hours preparation time)
8. Teamwork Assignment Complete the Teamwork Assignment (TwA) digitally, with your assigned team.	**2nd Mar – 9th Mar 23:59 CET**	2 hours
9. Ranking Studielink informs student of rank#	**15th April**	
10. Accept & Finalize A. Accept your spot within 2 weeks B. Finalize registration in Studielink (and Osiaan for international students)		

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